



To the
Council for Tropical and
Subtropical Agricultural Research (ATSAF)
University of Hohenheim

**Faculty of Agricultural Sciences
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Support letter for Lokesh Goud Dabbi

Dear ATSAF Team,

I am writing to provide my full support for the application of Mr. Lokesh Goud Dabbi for the ATSAF - CGIAR++ Junior Scientist Tandem Program. I hereby confirm that I will supervise his Master's thesis with the research topic

“Long-Term Assessment of Soil Properties under Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF) Compared with Conventional Rice Cropping Systems.”

This research will be conducted partly as an internship in collaboration with Dr. Leigh Winowiecki from CGIAR-World Agroforestry and Dr. Zakir Hussain from Raithu Sadhikara Samstha (RySS). Lokesh Goud Dabbi is currently pursuing his Master's degree in Organic Agriculture and Food Systems at the University of Hohenheim. Throughout his academic journey, he has demonstrated strong organizational skills, critical thinking abilities, and creativity. He has also gained valuable experience through internships and projects in both national and international contexts, including GIZ India, the Indian Institute of Rice Research, and he represented the Coalition for Soil Health (CA4SH) Youth Wing, Youth4Soil, at the UNCCD COP16 in Riyadh. Additionally, he gave an oral presentation on Achieving Land Degradation Neutrality through Evidence-Based Policy and Practice at the UNCCD COP16 and participated in the UN FAO World Food Forum 2024. Apart from his studies, he also served as an Eco-volunteer in Cyprus under the European Solidarity Corps (ESC) project, which focused on the EU's 8th Environmental Action Plan. Moreover, he has been selected as a Climate Pact Ambassador from Germany for 2025 under DG CLIMA, European Commission. His internships and student research assistant roles at the University of Hohenheim and his current internship at LUFA Speyer further demonstrate his dedication and motivation for research.

The proposed research project for his Master's thesis will evaluate the impacts of APCNF sustainable farming practices on soil health, food security, and environmental sustainability. This

work also shows a way to address critical global challenges in sustainable agriculture and food systems. I am confident that Lokesh Goud Dabbi's involvement in this project, in collaboration with CGIAR—World Agroforestry and RySS (APCNF), will provide him with a highly valuable learning opportunity and further develop his skills and expertise.

Lokesh Goud Dabbi has consistently committed to academic excellence and research. His motivation and ability to conduct research at a high academic level are evident, and I do not doubt his capacity to complete this program successfully.

Therefore, I wholeheartedly support his application for the Junior Scientist Tandem Program and have full confidence in his abilities and determination to succeed in this endeavor.

Thank you for considering his application.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Torsten Müller', with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

Prof. Dr. Torsten Müller